DRAFT

Accessible Evacuation Planning

Write a person-directed plan for the assistance, information, equipment, and time you need to leave safely and stay at a destination.

EVS-010

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Leave before conditions become unsafe when officials tell you to evacuate. If danger is immediate, use the safest available way to reach safety and tell responders what assistance you want. This worksheet does not replace instructions from emergency officials or individualized advice from your clinician, pharmacist, equipment supplier, or manufacturer.

PLAN FOR DISRUPTED ROUTINES

Plan for **loss of power, separation from your usual support, inaccessible routes, and communication failures**. A diagnosis does not tell another person what assistance you need. Describe what works for you, ask before assistance is given, and revise this plan whenever your needs or circumstances change.

Name I want used: _____ **Plan date:** _____

Where I keep a portable copy: _____

1. COMMUNICATION, LANGUAGE, AND ALERTS

My preferred language: _____ **Interpreter type, if wanted:** _____

My preferred ways to communicate (speech, text, writing, sign, device, communication board, other):

_____

Give alerts or instructions to me this way (visual, audible, vibration, plain language, large print, captioning, relay, other):

_____

Allow this time or use these steps so I can receive, understand, and respond:

_____

If power, cellular service, internet, or my usual device fails, use:

_____

- ☐ I enrolled in the alert methods I choose and tested their accessibility.
- ☐ I keep alerts, contacts, and instructions in more than one format.
- ☐ My communication device, charger, batteries, adapters, and low-tech backup travel with me.

DRAFT

EVS-010

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

2. MOBILITY, TRANSFER, AND WAYFINDING

How I move or navigate; mobility devices I use: _____

Assistance I want with guiding, stairs, boarding, transfers, positioning, or balance:

_____

Ask or tell me before helping by: _____

Do not lift, guide, transfer, fold, or secure me or my equipment this way:

_____

Backup route or method if elevators, curb cuts, lighting, or the usual route cannot be used:

_____

Transportation assistance and loading time I need: _____

Practice only in a safe setting. Have the person direct assistance; helpers should not improvise a lift, transfer, tie-down, or equipment-handling technique.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

3. MEDICINES, SUPPLIES, EQUIPMENT, AND POWER

Keep detailed clinical information only where you choose. Ask the appropriate professional to verify product-specific instructions; do not guess about doses, refrigeration time, power connections, or device runtime.

Item or need	What must travel	Storage, power, or backup plan	Prescriber, pharmacy, supplier, or support contact
Medicine(s)	_____	_____	_____
Refrigerated item(s)	_____	_____	_____
Medical or personal-care supplies	_____	_____	_____
Durable medical equipment	_____	_____	_____
Power-dependent equipment	_____	_____	_____

Allergies or urgent information I choose to share: _____

If refrigeration is interrupted, my pharmacist, clinician, or manufacturer says to:

_____

If equipment or power is unavailable, my verified clinical contingency plan is kept:

_____

- ☐ I have a current medicine list and enough legal, safely stored supplies for my plan.
- ☐ I have compatible chargers, batteries, adapters, and a professionally reviewed backup-power plan.
- ☐ I know how supplies and equipment will travel with me, not in a separate vehicle unless I choose and can remain safe.
- ☐ I have written shutdown, transport, storage, cleaning, and restart instructions for exact equipment models.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

4. PERSONAL ASSISTANCE AND BACKUP PEOPLE

Assistance I want with personal care, eating, drinking, positioning, communication, decision support, or other activities:

_____

Primary caregiver/helper and agreed responsibilities:

_____

Backup helper and agreed responsibilities: _____

If my usual support person and I are separated, I will:

_____

Out-of-area contact and how to reach them: _____

Share the minimum information each person needs. Confirm that every helper agrees to the role, knows how you direct assistance, and has a backup if they are affected by the same emergency.

5. SERVICE-ANIMAL PLAN

Animal's name and task-related support helpers should know: _____

Food, water, medicines, harness/leash, waste supplies, records, and other items packed:

_____

Relief routine or location needs: _____

Backup handler, veterinarian, or care plan if I cannot provide care:

_____

Do not distract, feed, handle, or separate a service animal from its handler without the handler's permission. Plan for the animal to evacuate with the handler and for needed supplies to remain together.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

6. PICKUP, TRANSPORTATION, AND DESTINATIONS

Confirm each arrangement directly before an emergency and again when conditions change.

Plan	Primary choice	Backup choice
Accessible pickup point	_____	_____
Route to pickup point	_____	_____
Transportation provider/method	_____	_____
Destination or shelter	_____	_____
Reunification location	_____	_____

Pickup point features I need (level route, curb access, lighting, seating, weather cover, other):

_____

Transportation capacity to confirm: person plus _____ support person(s), _____ mobility device(s), service animal, and these essential supplies/equipment: _____

Vehicle access, lift/ramp, securement, seating, transfer, or loading needs:

_____

Destination features to confirm: accessible route and entrance; toilet and bathing access; cot or sleeping arrangement; communication access; charging or backup power; refrigeration; personal assistance; service-animal relief area; and any other support I need.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

My requirements and confirmation notes:

_____

EVS-010

⌖ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

Local details must be verified with the responsible organization. Keep all registry, paratransit, assistance-program, phone-number, eligibility, enrollment, pickup, capacity, and shelter-accessibility information in this block until verified. Services, eligibility, capacity, and accessibility can change; record who confirmed each fact and when.

[VERIFY] Local emergency-management or registry program:

_____

Phone/website: _____ Eligibility or enrollment rules: _____

What the program does and does not provide: _____

Confirmed by responsible organization/representative: _____ Date: _____

[VERIFY] Paratransit or accessible evacuation transportation:

_____

Phone/website: _____ Eligibility, reservation, and activation rules: _____

Vehicle/device/passenger capacity: _____

Confirmed by responsible organization/representative: _____ Date: _____

[VERIFY] Assistance program or accessible destination/shelter:

_____

Phone/website: _____ Eligibility or admission rules: _____

Accessibility and support features confirmed: _____

Confirmed by responsible organization/representative: _____ Date: _____

Registration is not a guarantee of rescue, transportation, priority power restoration, admission, or a particular service. Keep a primary and backup plan and request help early.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

7. EQUIPMENT IDENTIFICATION AND HANDLING NOTES

Attach additional manufacturer or clinician instructions if needed. Do not include information you do not want to share.

Equipment	Make/model/serial number	Travels or stores this way	Setup, shutdown, handling, or safety note	Supplier/support
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Where verified instructions are kept: _____

Parts that must stay together / parts that must not be removed:

_____

Who may operate or assist with this equipment: _____

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

8. PERSONAL SUPPORT NETWORK

Ask each person first. A confirmation means the person understands and accepts the role; it does not transfer control of your plan or authorize assistance you do not want.

Person and relationship	Contact method(s)	Location	Agreed role	Backup if unavailable	Confirmed/date
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Who checks on me first: _____ **When:** _____

Who brings supplies/equipment: _____ **Access arrangement:** _____

Who contacts the out-of-area person: _____ **How we confirm completion:** _____

What helpers should do if communication fails:

_____

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

9. PRACTICE AND ASK-FOR-HELP TRIGGERS

Practice communication, check-in, route, loading, equipment, destination, and reunification parts separately if a full exercise would be unsafe. Never interrupt essential power, medicine, oxygen, or care to test this plan without appropriate professional guidance.

Practice or review	Date completed	What worked / what must change	Next date
Alert and communication backup	_____	_____	_____
Network check-in and separation plan	_____	_____	_____
Route and accessible pickup point	_____	_____	_____
Vehicle boarding and equipment capacity	_____	_____	_____
Destination confirmation	_____	_____	_____

I will request help early when (check and complete the triggers that apply to me):

- ☐ An evacuation warning or other official trigger occurs: _____
- ☐ My usual route, elevator, vehicle, caregiver, or communication method may become unavailable.
- ☐ Power is expected to be lost or my verified backup threshold is reached: _____
- ☐ Medicine, refrigeration, oxygen, battery, or supply reserve reaches my verified threshold: _____
- ☐ Weather, smoke, flooding, heat, traffic, or another condition will make leaving harder if I wait.
- ☐ My primary helper does not confirm by: _____
- ☐ Another person-directed trigger: _____

Who I contact first and by what method: _____

Backup action if no one responds: _____

KEEP THIS PLAN USABLE

Review it after every practice, move, change in support, medicine or equipment change, and at the interval you choose. Protect private information; carry only what you need and share it only with people you choose.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

RELATED HANDOUTS

Use this worksheet with STH-004 — Disability & Access Planning; caregivers may also use STH-005 — Child & Caregiver Planning. For readiness, go-bags, leave-early decisions, routes, transportation, and children or animals, see EVS-001, EVS-002, EVS-003, EVS-004, EVS-005, and EVS-006. Check the binder index for availability; handouts still in development may not yet appear there.

SOURCES

Sources and further planning guidance

U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Ready.gov, “Individuals with Disabilities.”

U.S. Department of Justice, ADA.gov, “Emergency Planning.”

U.S. Food and Drug Administration, “Emergency Power Planning Checklist.”

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Administration for Community Living, “Emergency Preparedness Resources for People with Disabilities.”

Federal Emergency Management Agency, “Guidance on Planning for Integration of Functional Needs Support Services in General Population Shelters.”

Accessed 2026-09-25.